

Cross-Cultural Attitudes to AI Resurrection Tools & Digital Legacy: An Exploratory Survey

I'm Tulin Bayramoglu and I am a Master's student in Interdisciplinary Problems & Methods at the London Interdisciplinary School (LIS). This survey will, in part, inform my Capstone Dissertation project supervised by Waqas Ahmed.

I really appreciate your time, honesty and authenticity - thank you for supporting my research project!

* Required

Introduction & Consent

What is this study about?

A growing number of commercial AI platforms let people chat with a simulated version of someone who has died, built from that person's messages, voice recordings, or social media history. This research asks how different cultural and religious traditions shape a more comprehensive ethical picture, and what that means for practical aspects of life, like digital legacy planning in a legal will to inform further research, policy and education on this topic.

What to expect?

You will be asked general questions about cultural or family traditions around death and remembrance, and hypothetical attitudes toward AI memorial technology. This survey does not ask about any specific personal bereavement experiences. You may skip any question you do not feel comfortable answering.

More information can be found on this study and your participation here: [Participant Information Sheet](#)

Support

If you feel that your mental wellbeing has been affected by any issue that has come up in this study, please contact the Head of Student Support (student.support@lis.ac.uk) if you are a current LIS student. Otherwise, you are recommended to contact [The Samaritans](#) on 116 123 for a free call with a trained volunteer, or text SHOUT to 85258 for text-based support. You may also contact [Cruse Bereavement Support](#) for free support on 0808 808 1677.

Consent

In accordance with LIS's ethical guidelines and the Data Protection Act 1998, no personal information will be stored, and your responses will remain anonymous. IP addresses will not be recorded. The data will only be used for research purposes and will not be shared, except if teaching staff request proof of data collection. Data is only to be used only for this dissertation and directly related academic outputs. Participation in this survey is entirely voluntary and you may withdraw at any time while completing the survey.

By selecting 'Yes, I consent to take part', you confirm that:

- 1. You understand the purpose and content of this research and what is required from you as a volunteer participant.
- 2. You acknowledge that your responses will remain anonymous, and no personal information will be recorded.
- 3. You understand that participation is voluntary and that you may withdraw without reason at any time during the survey.
- 4. You are 18 years old
- 5. This survey does not expect you to disclose any specific personal bereavement experiences.

By selecting 'No, I do not wish to continue', you can exit the survey.

For any queries, contact the researcher: tulin.bayramoglu@lis.ac.uk

1. Do you consent to take part in this survey? *

- ☐ Yes, I consent to take part
- ☐ No, I do not wish to continue

Section 1: About You

2. Please create a unique personal identifier.

For example, a combination of letters and numbers from your mother's maiden name and a pet's date of birth or a niche interest (MLK30 or cyanotype9).

This can be used to identify you if you wish to withdraw from participating at any time so your data can be securely deleted.
Please DO NOT include any identifiable personal information (e.g name). *

3. What is your age range? *

- ☐ 18 - 24
- ☐ 25 - 34
- ☐ 35 - 44
- ☐ 45 - 54
- ☐ 55 - 64
- ☐ 65 - 74
- ☐ 75+

4. What country do you currently live in? *

5. How would you describe your cultural or ethnic background? *

6. What is your religious or spiritual tradition? *

- ☐ Catholic (incl. Roman Catholic and Orthodox)
- ☐ Protestant (United Church of Canada, Anglican, Orthodox, Baptist, Lutheran)
- ☐ Christian Orthodox
- ☐ Jewish
- ☐ Muslim
- ☐ Sikh
- ☐ Hindu
- ☐ Buddhist
- ☐ Atheist (do not believe in God)
- ☐ Agnostic (not sure if there is a God)
- ☐ Nothing in particular/Not sure
- ☐ Prefer not to say
- ☐ Other

7. How much does religion or cultural tradition shape your everyday decisions?

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

8. How comfortable are you generally with using technology that is new or unfamiliar to you?

- ☐ Very comfortable
- ☐ Somewhat comfortable
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Somewhat uncomfortable
- ☐ Very uncomfortable

Section 2: Death & Memorial Practices

None of the following questions ask about a specific personal loss. You may skip ahead if you wish not to respond.

9. In your cultural or family tradition, how common is it to visit graves or memorial sites?

- ☐ Very common
- ☐ Somewhat common
- ☐ Uncommon
- ☐ Not practised
- ☐ Not sure

10. Do families in your tradition typically keep a home shrine, altar, photos, or a dedicated memorial space for deceased relatives?

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

11. In your tradition, how normal is it to speak to or about deceased loved ones as though they are still present?

For example addressing them directly, asking for guidance, or informing them of news.

- ☐ Very normal
- ☐ Somewhat normal
- ☐ Unusual
- ☐ Not practised
- ☐ Not sure

12. Which statement best reflects your own view, regardless of your background?

- ☐ The dead should be remembered, but ongoing interaction with them is not something I would consider normal or appropriate
- ☐ Ongoing communication or connection with those who have died is a normal, healthy part of remembrance
- ☐ It depends entirely on the method, some forms of ongoing connection feel appropriate, others do not
- ☐ I have not thought about this before

Section 3: Awareness and Attitudes Toward AI Digital Resurrection Tools

None of the following questions ask about a specific personal loss. You may skip ahead if you wish not to respond.

13. Before this survey, had you heard of AI tools that let you chat with a simulation of a deceased person, sometimes called griefbots or deadbots?

For context, these are commercial apps and platforms that use AI to simulate the voice, personality, or conversational style of someone who has died, usually built from that person's messages, voice recordings, or social media history.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

14. How comfortable would you personally feel using such a tool to interact with a simulation of a deceased family member?

- ☐ Very comfortable
- ☐ Somewhat comfortable
- ☐ Neither comfortable nor uncomfortable
- ☐ Somewhat uncomfortable
- ☐ Very uncomfortable

15. How comfortable would you feel if, after you pass away, a family member used such a tool to interact with a simulation of you?

- ☐ Very comfortable
- ☐ Somewhat comfortable
- ☐ Neither comfortable nor uncomfortable
- ☐ Somewhat uncomfortable
- ☐ Very uncomfortable

16. To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statement:

I would want to be clearly told, before starting, that I am talking to an AI simulation and not a real person.

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

17. To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statement:

A platform should not be allowed to create a chatbot of a deceased person without that person's own consent, given while they were alive.

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

18. To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statement:

Using AI to simulate a deceased person risks disrespecting their memory or dignity.

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

19. To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statement:

These platforms are likely to work better for people who are already comfortable with technology and have a lot of their life stored online.

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

20. To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statement:

It is inappropriate to charge an ongoing subscription fee to keep talking to a simulation of a deceased loved one.

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

21. Which of the following concerns would matter most to you?

Select up to three.

Please select at most 3 options.

- ☐ Whether the deceased person consented to being simulated
- ☐ Accuracy or authenticity of the simulation
- ☐ Cost or subscription model
- ☐ Whether it is appropriate within my religious or cultural tradition
- ☐ Risk of becoming emotionally dependent on it
- ☐ Data privacy and who owns the data
- ☐ Other

22. Would you be interested in trying an educational tool that explains how this technology works?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ Maybe
- ☐ No

23. In one or two sentences, what does your cultural or religious background teach about how the dead should be remembered, if anything?

Section 4: Digital Legacy and Wills

You may skip ahead if you wish not to respond.

24. Do you currently have a legal will?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ In progress
- ☐ Not sure
- ☐ Prefer not to say

25. Before today, had you thought about what happens to your digital accounts, photos, or messages after you die?

- ☐ Extensively
- ☐ A lot
- ☐ Somewhat
- ☐ Very little
- ☐ Not at all

26. If a will writing service offered a digital legacy section, how likely would you be to include it?

For example, instructions for social media accounts, whether an AI simulation of you may be created, or what to do with photos and messages.

- ☐ Extremely likely
- ☐ Somewhat likely
- ☐ Neutral / Neither likely nor unlikely
- ☐ Somewhat unlikely
- ☐ Extremely unlikely

27. Has learning about AI resurrection tools today made you more likely to write or update a will?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure
- ☐ Prefer not to say

Section 5: Final thoughts

28. Do you find this survey/research topic interesting?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Maybe

29. What, if anything, would need to change for you to feel more comfortable with this kind of technology?

30. What appeals to you, if anything, about this kind of technology?

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